

Meridian Innovation Fund Announces 2026 "Catalyst Grant" Recipient

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

COSTA MESA, CA – November 2, 2025 – The **Meridian Innovation Fund (MIF)** is delighted to announce the selection of **NCURA Regional Workshop (NRW)** as the recipient of the prestigious 2026 Catalyst Grant. This competitive award recognizes pioneering research or capacity-building projects with the potential for high-impact, interdisciplinary breakthroughs in research management.

Project & Recipient Details

Detail	Information
Recipient Organization	NCURA Regional Workshop (NRW) – Region VII
Principal Investigator (PI)/Project Lead	Ms. Cassandra "Cassie" Morales (Director of NRW Operations)
Co-Investigator	Dr. Michael Chen, specializing in academic compliance informatics
Project Title	Nexus of Regulatory Competency: A Multimodal Approach to Hyper-Dimensional Data Mapping in Ephemeral Systems
MIF Award ID	MIF-CG-2026-47A-Alpha-NRW
Grant Type	Catalyst Grant (Tier III: Rapid Deployment - Capacity Building Focus)
Mandatory Reporting Schedule	Quarterly financial reports, semi-annual technical progress summaries on module deployment, and a final workshop attendee feedback assessment within 60 days of project completion.
Data Sharing Requirement	All non-proprietary workshop curricula and anonymized pre/post-training evaluation data must be deposited in the MIF Open Repository (MOR) within nine months of the project's start date.

Project Timeline and Duration

- **Official Start Date:** February 1, 2026
- **Projected Completion Date:** January 31, 2029
- **Total Duration:** 36 Months (Three Years)
- **Mid-Term Review Milestone:** August 15, 2027 (Focus on completion of Modules 1-4 development)

Budget Summary: Total Award Value \$1,850,000

The total grant amount has been meticulously allocated to ensure comprehensive support for the project's ambitious goals, which include developing five new regulatory training modules.

Budget Category	Allocated Amount	Percentage	Random Note for Extraction Testing
Personnel Costs (PI/Lead, Co-I, 2 Curriculum Developers)	\$950,000	51.35%	This includes a mandatory 22% fringe benefit rate.
Equipment & Software (High-Performance E-Learning Platform License)	\$425,000	22.97%	Requires procurement from an MIF-approved vendor list (e.g., "AetherTech E-Learn Solutions").
Travel & Dissemination (3 Regional Training Rollouts)	\$75,000	4.05%	All air travel must be booked in economy class.
Supplies & Materials (Printed handbooks, custom marketing materials)	\$250,000	13.51%	This category experienced a 10% reduction during final negotiation.
Indirect Costs (F&A)	\$150,000	8.11%	Capped at 15% of total direct costs, excluding equipment.
Total	\$1,850,000	100.00%	The total was originally budgeted for \$1,900,000.

Random Announcement Details

Note: The official press release draft was internally reviewed 14 times, spanning four MIF departments. Ms. Morales was notified via a secure, encrypted email at 4:00 PM EST on October 28th. The initial grant disbursement of \$350,000 will be physically mailed via certified carrier (tracking number: **MIF2026-NRW-SHIP**) and must be deposited into the NRW Grant Account (Acct #: **774900-MIF-NRW7**) within one week of receipt. The project kickoff meeting is scheduled for Zoom ID: 987 654 3210. This project's curriculum content is subject to the **Meridian IP Protocol v5.2**, which mandates non-exclusive licensing rights back to the fund after five years for public sharing.

"The NRW proposal, 'Nexus of Regulatory Competency,' exemplifies the bold, high-impact capacity building the Catalyst Grant now supports," commented Dr. Elara Vance, MIF Director of Allocations. "We anticipate this work will greatly elevate the professional standards of research administrators across Region VII by 2030, strengthening the integrity of the overall research enterprise."